There are certain traits that serve you badly in this work: being thin-skinned, certainly, self-pitying, absolutely, and I have probably had to fight hard not to succumb to these. I have a strong sense of self-command, but it vexes me when the world won't listen, and I can only hope to get better when it comes to managing my mistakes. We're a young organisation, and the work we've done has thrown us into the spotlight very quickly. Personally, I've had to learn on the job and take pride in the effort. If we're a people's bureau of investigation, then it's the people we have to keep in mind, while the reaction from left and right will often be hostile. Publishing the Baghdad video was the right thing to do and was not only consistent with our sense of what we were set up to do, but the acme of our moral stance. Millions of people in Iraq and Afghanistan have been living with these aerial attacks and we judged it imperative that people get an insight into how they could go wrong. There will always be people lining up to say, 'This is just war, no battle zone is a playground, innocent people get killed,' and all that, but people should not be forced or coerced into taking these judgements on trust. They should see the evidence for themselves. There had been a cover-up, and, whether coming from a four-star general or a presenter on Fox News, the call to hide such truths from the population is dastardly. War is always a manipulation, but it serves the people amongst whom the war is being fought very badly, and does nothing for long-term peace, when the people conducting those wars are so willing to prosecute them in a flurry of bad faith. We called the US on that, as we would call any nation, and we did so not to make our lives easier – it begins a ghastly period of public renown for me – but to pursue an ideal of openness and accountability without which no true democracy can function. The fact that the US military refused to open a public investigation is shaming to the notion of moral responsibility. But the video, like the pictures from Abu Ghraib, was a crucial piece of the reality jigsaw in that conflict. And the picture presented by these things would bring the war to an end.

We had already published the classified 'Rules of Engagement for Iraq' in 2008, and we collected those documents and posted them on the collateralmurder.net website we had created to host the video, and encouraged people to read them as well as watch the video. The rules show that the behaviour of those in *Crazy Horse*, the Apache helicopter that swooped so eagerly to end the lives of twelve men and injure two children, was not permissible, under those same rules. 'Permission to engage' was